

4.1 Unit description

Independent reading and research

This unit allows teachers and students **free choice of texts**, unrestrained by date requirements or genre, in order to undertake independent reading and research. The three texts chosen could include works of literary criticism or cultural commentary. They should not be texts that have previously been assessed in any other unit. Texts may be studied and tasks chosen for the group or the individual as appropriate to the centre.

The texts may relate to each other in a variety of ways, such as by movement, period or author.

The requirement that **three** texts should be 'studied' in this unit should be interpreted to mean that, in preparation for writing coursework, students will study one text in detail, drawing upon their knowledge of a further text(s) and/or exploring relevant critical reception.

Teachers and students may take the opportunity to develop interests aroused by the study of texts in other units or by types of texts not considered elsewhere.

As readers and critics of literary texts, students should demonstrate that they have synthesised and reflected upon their knowledge and understanding gained throughout the course. Together with Unit 3, this unit is synoptic and requires students to demonstrate that they can read and respond independently and with increasing depth in their responses.

To support informed student choices of texts further guidance is provided in the tutor support materials.